

FOR EMPLOYERS · BROKERS · HR TEAMS

The Employer Brief

**A practical guide to
\$0-employer-cost virtual primary
care.**

Inside: who we treat, what it costs, what we cannot do, and how a one-page agreement gets your team live in a week.



01 · THE PROBLEM

Employer healthcare keeps getting more expensive — and the workers who need primary care most can't get it.

Three numbers explain why a \$0–employer–cost virtual primary care benefit is showing up on more broker and HR shortlists in 2026.

\$17,496

Average annual employer cost per employee for health coverage in 2025¹, up 6% YoY

27.8%

Uninsured rate in construction & extraction — second-highest of any occupation²

22.0%

Uninsured rate in food prep & serving²; 21.9% in cleaning; 14.9% in transportation

\$1,685

Annual lost productivity per employee from unmanaged–illness absenteeism³

Most employer benefit conversations focus on the first number. This brief focuses on the other three — because they are where TeleDirectMD has something to offer.

1. Mercer National Survey of Employer–Sponsored Health Plans, 2025: [mercer.com](https://www.mercer.com)

2. US Census Bureau, Health Insurance Coverage by Occupation, September 2025: [census.gov](https://www.census.gov)

3. CDC absenteeism data via TeamSense, 2025: [teamsense.com](https://www.teamsense.com)

02 · WHAT TELEDIRECTMD IS

A physician-led virtual primary care practice. Not insurance, not a network — a doctor your team can actually reach.

TeleDirectMD is the solo physician practice of Parth Bhavsar, MD — a board-certified Family Medicine physician licensed in 41 states plus the District of Columbia. The practice is direct-to-patient and direct-to-employer: same physician every visit, transparent flat pricing, no insurance coordination required.

YOUR BUSINESS PAYS

\$0

No PEPM, no per-visit fees, no contracts with money in them.

YOUR EMPLOYEE PAYS

\$59

vs. \$79 retail. Same-day visits. HSA/FSA eligible.

OR USE INSURANCE

In-Network

BCBS · Aetna ·
UnitedHealthcare
commercial plans (select
states).

How it works

- One-page partnership agreement. Month-to-month, terminate at-will. No PEPM, no per-visit fee billed to the employer.
- Enrollment code for your team. Employees self-enroll. The benefit is voluntary and employee-pay-all.
- Same physician every visit. No carrier-bundled rotation. Continuity of care is real, not a marketing line.
- Same-day or next-day visits. Including evenings and weekends.
- HSA / FSA / ICHRA / QSEHRA eligible. A \$59 video visit is an IRS-qualified medical expense.

03 · WHAT WE TREAT — AND WHAT WE HONESTLY CANNOT DO

Scope is everything.

Telehealth marketing often blurs the line between primary care and occupational health. We don't. Here is what's in scope, and what isn't — written plainly so brokers, HR, and compliance counsel can evaluate fit without surprises.

WHAT WE DO

- + Hypertension, diabetes (non-insulin), dyslipidemia
- + Depression and anxiety (SSRIs, SNRIs)
- + Acute illness: UTI, sinus, sore throat, skin infections, GI
- + Contact dermatitis, eczema, rashes
- + Standard asthma and reflux management
- + Lab orders, prescription refills, work-excuse notes
- + Visits in 41 states + DC, same MD every time

WHAT WE DO NOT DO

- DOT physical exams (49 CFR §391.43 requires in-person)
- Controlled substances (no opioids, stimulants, benzodiazepines)
- OSHA medical surveillance (1910.134 respirators, silica, lead)
- TB testing / Hep B titers / vaccine administration
- Sutures, abscess drainage, in-person procedures
- Pediatric care (adults 18+ only)
- Workers' comp clinical packages or food handler cards

Why we publish what we cannot do. Buyers ask anyway, and an honest answer up front saves everyone time. If your team needs OSHA medical surveillance, food handler cards, TB testing, or DOT exams, those workflows go through occupational medicine vendors — and should. TeleDirectMD is built for the ongoing primary care between those events.

04 · HOW IT WORKS

From first call to first visit, typically a week.

01 Discovery call

15 minutes with Dr. Bhavsar or a TeleDirectMD team member. We confirm state coverage for your workforce, walk through how the benefit slots into your existing plan, and answer compliance questions (ERISA voluntary-plan safe harbor, HSA/FSA, ICHRA/QSEHRA).

02 One-page partnership agreement

Month-to-month, terminate at-will. The agreement is one page and contains no PEPM, per-visit, or per-employee fee billed to the business. Reviewed and signed digitally.

03 Enrollment code for your team

We issue an employer-branded enrollment code your employees use at signup to access the \$59 rate instead of \$79 retail. Distribute the code via email, intranet, or printed flyer — however your team communicates.

04 Your team starts booking

Employees book directly with Dr. Bhavsar — same-day or next-day, including evenings and weekends. No HR involvement after launch. We share aggregate utilization metrics quarterly.

05 · INDUSTRY FIT

Where this benefit moves the needle.

Every employer can use \$0-cost telehealth, but five industries get disproportionate value because of uninsured rates, workforce health profile, and the cost of clinic detours.

Trucking & Logistics OTR drivers and owner-operators. We manage hypertension, diabetes, cholesterol, mental health between DOT exams. We do not perform DOT physicals.

Restaurants & Hospitality Minor burns and cuts, contact dermatitis, GI illness, mental health for late-shift workers. 22% of food-service workers carry no health insurance.

Home Care & Home Health 87% female, 38.5% age 55+ workforce. Back and shoulder pain, chronic disease management, acute illness. TB / Hep B credentialing goes through OccMed vendors.

Construction & Trades 27.8% uninsured — second-highest of any occupation. Hypertension, MSK pain within virtual scope, mental health. OSHA respirator clearances stay with OccMed.

Cleaning & Janitorial Night-shift accessible. Contact dermatitis, standard asthma management, chronic disease, mental health. Interpreter support for immigrant-heavy workforce.

Each industry has its own page at teledirectmd.com/employers with primary-source clinical citations.

06 · COMPLIANCE POSTURE

Why benefits counsel can sign off without redlines.

Most novel benefit arrangements get stuck in legal review for weeks. TeleDirectMD's structure is designed to fall within established safe harbors — so your benefits counsel has a short read, not a long memo.

ERISA voluntary-plan safe harbor

The partnership is structured as a voluntary, employee-pay-all arrangement intended to fall within the DOL's voluntary-plan safe harbor (29 CFR 2510.3-1(j)). The employer's role is limited to permitting employee access. We recommend you consult your benefits counsel for your specific plan-design context.

HSA / FSA / HRA eligibility

\$59 telehealth visits are IRS-qualified medical expenses. Visits are HSA / FSA eligible, and reimbursable through ICHRA, QSEHRA, and standard HRA plan designs.

HIPAA-compliant platform

Patient data is handled under HIPAA. Dr. Bhavsar's practice uses a HIPAA-compliant EHR and video-visit platform. Business Associate Agreements available on request.

LegitScript certified

TeleDirectMD holds LegitScript Healthcare Merchant Certification — required for payment processing in regulated healthcare verticals and a meaningful trust signal for compliance officers.

Florida broker exclusion

Florida brokers are excluded from the \$250 finder's fee program pending counsel review of the Florida Patient Brokering Act. This exclusion is on the program page and in the broker agreement — no surprises.

07 · NEXT STEPS

Three ways to move this forward this week.

FOR HR & EMPLOYERS

Book a 15-minute call

Dr. Bhavsar or our team will walk you through state coverage, plan design, and timing.

teledirectmd.com/employers

FOR BROKERS

\$250 per signed employer

Flat finder's fee. Not commission, not volume-tiered. ACH within 30 days of activation.

teledirectmd.com/employers/brokers

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About Dr. Parth Bhavsar, MD



Parth Bhavsar, MD is a Board-Certified Family Medicine Physician and founder of TeleDirectMD. Residency: University of Mississippi Medical Center (UMMC), 2021. NPI 1104323203. Licensed in 41 states + DC. Featured in TIME, Newsweek, HuffPost, Fox News, US News, Parade, and British GQ. 5.0 stars across 125 verified reviews on Healthgrades, ZocDoc, WebMD, and Google.